

1. I can clearly imagine a scenario in which I exist, but no material things exist.
2. If I can clearly imagine something being the case, then it is possible for it to be the case.
3. It is possible that I exist and no material things exist. (1,2)
4. If it is possible that I exist and no material things exist, then materialist theories of survival are false.

C. Materialist theories of survival are false. (3,4)

THE CONCEIVABILITY ARGUMENT

“Should ... the consciousness of the prince’s past life, enter and inform the body of a cobbler ... everyone sees, he would be the same person with the prince, accountable only for the prince’s actions.”

Locke is imagining a scenario now familiar from various movies and TV shows: the idea that we can imagine one person waking up one morning in someone else's body.

We can turn this into an argument against materialist theories.

Why might one endorse psychological continuity? One kind of argument is a **swapping argument**. Here is the classic argument, due to John Locke:

Imagine that 'you' wake up in the body of the cobbler. The psychological theory of survival can say that this really is you. The materialist, it seems, will say that it is still the cobbler — but with some surprising new memories.

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Exilis + .

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Survival is:

existential

3. It is possible that I

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4. If it is possible that I

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Survival analysis (3,4)

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